whom he allocated a mere fragment of what was decided in the coalition negotiations, while he allocated huge sums to Minister Orit Strook, of his own Religious Zionist Party, much beyond what her new ministry can use.

All eyes are riveted on the three days of budget discussions and on the votes starting tomorrow. If no solution is found by the end of the week, one last day will be granted to the coalition: the following Monday, May 28. The comic side of this dramatic situation comes from the fact that the coalition partners do not believe in any promises about future compensation that Netanyahu could give, because they know that his promises are simply not kept.

*Monday, May 22*

In a speech in Herzliah yesterday, Gantz alluded to a compromise in the making in the negotiations at the President's Residence. The coalition doesn't want to publicize it before the vote on the budget.

In a conversation between Netanyahu and the minister of Torah Judaism, (the ultra-Orthodox) Yitzhak Goldknopf, a deal was reached: the party would get the amount they wanted from the surpluses in the overall budget at the end of the year. Either there were some unpublished additional aspects to the deal, or the ultras have decided to let go of their demands.

Ben-Gvir pretends that he doesn't yet know whether his party will support the budget or not, but it is hard to see him bringing down the only government that gives him a spot and the opportunity to perform his antics.

Netanyahu has promised Ben-Gvir a further 250 million shekels for the Ministry of the Negev and the Galilee, and the evil clown will vote for the budget. The crisis is over.

With the budgetary question resolved and a possible compromise regarding the judicial overhaul, the governmental coalition will sail on for some time and we can say goodbye to the hopes raised by the popular